

C816

Healthcare System Applications

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A 180-bed hospital whose CIO recently spoke at a national conference wants to replace its lab system. The project charter is approved and funded. A vendor with an attractive booth demo is pushing for a signed contract next week. What should the team do next in the SDLC?

- A. Analysis: gather and document user and functional requirements.
- B. Sign with the vendor from the demo.
- C. Maintenance: patch the current lab system.
- D. Design the new screens.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A clinic's EHR, hosted in a data center that recently earned an energy-efficiency award, is backed up every 4 hours. Leadership decides that no more than 1 hour of patient data may ever be lost in an outage. The IT team has six staff. Which metric did leadership set, and does the current backup meet it?

- A. A 1-hour RPO; it is met because backups run several times a day.
- B. A 1-hour RTO; the backups meet it.
- C. A 1-hour RPO; the 4-hour backups do not meet it.
- D. A 4-hour RPO; it is met.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A hospital states that its pharmacy system must be back online within 2 hours after an outage. Which metric is this?

- A. Recovery time objective (RTO).
- B. Recovery point objective (RPO).
- C. Mean time between failures.
- D. An uptime percentage in the vendor contract.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A physician practice, which moved to a new office park last year, runs a full backup every Sunday night and an incremental backup every other night. The server fails Thursday morning, before that night's backup. The office manager keeps the backup drives in a fireproof safe. Which backups are needed to restore?

- A. Sunday's full plus only Wednesday's incremental.
- B. Only Sunday's full, since incrementals can never be restored.
- C. Sunday's full plus the Monday, Tuesday, and Wednesday incrementals.
- D. Only Wednesday's incremental.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A server has a full backup on Sunday and a differential backup each other night. It fails Friday morning before that night's backup. What is needed to restore?

- A. Sunday's full plus Thursday's differential.
- B. Every backup ever taken.
- C. Only Thursday's differential.
- D. Sunday's full plus the Monday through Thursday differentials.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

During a planned network outage at a hospital that recently opened a new parking deck, clinicians must keep admitting patients, giving medications, and documenting care while IT works to restore systems. The hospital's IT director is new. Which plan governs how clinicians keep working during the outage?

- A. None; stop documenting until systems return.
- B. The disaster recovery plan.
- C. The business continuity plan, including downtime procedures.
- D. The IT change management plan.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

An IT help desk at a health system with a new ticketing tool receives, in this order: a password reset for a billing clerk, a printer jam in the HIM office, and a report that the ED's medication-dispensing interface is down. The billing clerk has called three times. Which ticket is worked first?

- A. The password reset, because the clerk called three times.
- B. The password reset, because it arrived first.
- C. All three at once with equal priority.
- D. The ED medication-dispensing interface.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A project manager at a clinic network, who recently earned a PMP certificate, plans an EHR upgrade. Task A (4 weeks) must finish before Tasks B (3 weeks) and C (6 weeks), which can run in parallel. Task D (2 weeks) starts after both B and C finish. The vendor's help line is open 24/7. What is the shortest total project duration?

- A. 6 weeks
- B. 9 weeks
- C. 15 weeks
- D. 12 weeks

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A task that is not on the critical path has 3 weeks of slack. If it slips by 2 weeks, what happens to the project finish date?

- A. It moves 2 weeks later.
- B. It does not change.
- C. It moves 5 weeks later.
- D. It always moves, because any late task delays the project.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A 400-bed hospital that recently finished a lobby renovation is switching pharmacy systems. Leadership wants the lowest risk of losing orders during go-live and has budget for extra staff to enter data twice. The pharmacy director has 25 years of experience. Which conversion strategy fits?

- A.** Direct (big bang) cutover.
- B.** Parallel conversion.
- C.** Phased conversion.
- D.** Pilot conversion.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A small clinic with a tight budget and no staff time for double entry will switch all users to a new system on one date and retire the old one. Which strategy is this, and what is its main risk?

- A.** Pilot; limited risk to one unit.
- B.** Direct cutover; no risk because it is the simplest.
- C.** Parallel; low risk.
- D.** Direct cutover; if the new system fails there is no fallback.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A hospital's new scheduling module, built by an offshore team that works overnight, has passed unit and integration testing. Before go-live, front-desk schedulers will run real scenarios to confirm the system supports their daily work. The project is two weeks ahead of schedule. What kind of testing is this?

- A.** Regression testing.
- B.** User acceptance testing.
- C.** Unit testing.
- D.** None needed, since the project is ahead of schedule.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A 180-bed hospital ~~whose CIO recently spoke at a national conference~~ wants to replace its lab system. The project charter is approved and funded. ~~A vendor with an attractive booth demo is pushing for a signed contract next week.~~ What should the team do next in the SDLC?

Target word: next SDLC phase **Decides:** Planning is done; requirements are not.

A	Correct	Requirements must be defined before selecting or designing a system.
B	Camouflage	Reacts to vendor pressure; selection without requirements risks a poor fit.
C	Confusion set	Maintenance is the last phase of a system already in use, not the next step of a new project.
D	Dropped element	Skips analysis.

2. Answer C Concept 2

A clinic's EHR, hosted in a data center ~~that recently earned an energy efficiency award~~, is backed up every 4 hours. Leadership decides that no more than 1 hour of patient data may ever be lost in an outage. ~~The IT team has six staff.~~ Which metric did leadership set, and does the current backup meet it?

Target word: name metric and test it **Decides:** Allowed data loss (1 hour) vs. backup interval (4 hours).

A	Dropped element	Ignores the 4-hour gap between backups.
B	Confusion set	RTO is about downtime, not data loss.
C	Correct	Up to 4 hours of data could be lost, exceeding the 1-hour RPO.
D	Wrong stem number	Uses the backup interval as the objective.

3. Answer A Concept 2 · transfer

A hospital states that its pharmacy system must be back online within 2 hours after an outage. Which metric is this?

Target word: name the metric — reversed **Decides:** Time to restore service.

A	Correct	RTO is the maximum acceptable downtime.
B	Confusion set	RPO is acceptable data loss.
C	Adjacent category	MTBF measures reliability, not a recovery target.
D	Inverted operation	Uptime measures time running, the reverse of a restore deadline.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A physician practice, ~~which moved to a new office park last year~~, runs a full backup every Sunday night and an incremental backup every other night. The server fails Thursday morning, before that night's backup. ~~The office manager keeps the backup drives in a fireproof safe.~~ Which backups are needed to restore?

Target word: incremental restore set **Decides:** Incrementals each hold only changes since the previous backup.

A	Confusion set	That is the differential restore rule.
B	Absolute language	Incrementals are restorable and needed for recent data.
C	Correct	Each incremental is needed in order after the full.
D	Dropped element	Drops the full backup the incrementals build on.

5. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

A server has a full backup on Sunday and a differential backup each other night. It fails Friday morning before that night's backup. What is needed to restore?

Target word: differential restore set **Decides:** Each differential holds all changes since the full.

A	Correct	The latest differential contains every change since the full.
B	Absolute language	Only the last full and latest differential are needed.
C	Dropped element	Drops the full backup.
D	Inverted operation	Applies the incremental rule.

6. Answer C Concept 4

During a planned network outage at a hospital ~~that recently opened a new parking deck~~, clinicians must keep admitting patients, giving medications, and documenting care while IT works to restore systems. ~~The hospital's IT director is new.~~ Which plan governs how clinicians keep working during the outage?

Target word: which plan **Decides:** Keeping clinical operations going, not restoring IT.

A	Absolute language	Care and documentation continue on downtime forms.
B	Confusion set	DR restores IT systems; it does not tell clinicians how to work meanwhile.
C	Correct	Continuity planning keeps essential functions running.
D	Adjacent category	Change management controls system changes, not clinical downtime work.

7. Answer D Concept 5

An IT help desk at a health system ~~with a new ticketing tool~~ receives, in this order: a password reset for a billing clerk, a printer jam in the HIM office, and a report that the ED's medication-dispensing interface is down. ~~The billing clerk has called three times.~~ Which ticket is worked first?

Target word: priority **Decides:** Highest impact and urgency: patient safety in the ED.

A	Camouflage	Repeat calls do not raise impact.
B	Dropped element	Ignores impact and urgency.
C	Absolute language	Triage exists because tickets differ in impact.
D	Correct	It has the widest impact and a patient-safety urgency.

8. Answer D Concept 6

A project manager at a clinic network, ~~who recently earned a PMP certificate~~, plans an EHR upgrade. Task A (4 weeks) must finish before Tasks B (3 weeks) and C (6 weeks), which can run in parallel. Task D (2 weeks) starts after both B and C finish. ~~The vendor's help line is open 24/7.~~ What is the shortest total project duration?

Target word: project duration **Decides:** Longest path A → C → D.

A	Wrong stem number	That is the longest single task.
B	Inverted operation	Uses the shorter path A → B → D.
C	Confusion set	Adds all tasks as if B and C ran in sequence.
D	Correct	4 + 6 + 2 = 12 weeks along the critical path.

9. Answer B Concept 6 • transfer

A task that is not on the critical path has 3 weeks of slack. If it slips by 2 weeks, what happens to the project finish date?

Target word: effect of a slip within slack **Decides:** Slip (2) is less than slack (3).

A	Dropped element	Ignores the slack.
B	Correct	Slack absorbs delays up to its size.
C	Wrong stem number	Adds slack and slip.
D	Absolute language	Only critical-path delays, or slips beyond slack, move the finish.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A 400-bed hospital that recently finished a lobby renovation is switching pharmacy systems. Leadership wants the lowest risk of losing orders during go-live and has budget for extra staff to enter data twice. The pharmacy director has 25 years of experience. Which conversion strategy fits?

Target word: choose a conversion strategy **Decides:** Lowest risk with budget for double entry.

A	Inverted operation	Highest risk, with no fallback.
B	Correct	Running both systems lets staff fall back on the old one; it costs more but has the least risk.
C	Confusion set	Spreads modules over time; it is not the lowest-risk option for losing orders.
D	Adjacent category	Limits scope to one unit but does not keep a live fallback for every order.

11. Answer D Concept 7 • transfer

A small clinic with a tight budget and no staff time for double entry will switch all users to a new system on one date and retire the old one. Which strategy is this, and what is its main risk?

Target word: name strategy and its risk **Decides:** Everyone switches at once with no fallback.

A	Confusion set	All users switch together, so it is not a pilot.
B	Absolute language	Simplicity does not remove risk.
C	Inverted operation	Parallel runs both systems, which the clinic is not doing.
D	Correct	Big-bang conversion is cheapest but riskiest.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A hospital's new scheduling module, built by an offshore team that works overnight, has passed unit and integration testing. Before go-live, front-desk schedulers will run real scenarios to confirm the system supports their daily work. The project is two weeks ahead of schedule. What kind of testing is this?

Target word: name the test **Decides:** End users confirming it meets their needs.

A	Adjacent category	Regression checks that changes didn't break existing functions.
B	Correct	UAT has end users verify the system meets requirements.
C	Confusion set	Unit tests check individual components and are already done.
D	Camouflage	Schedule status does not replace user acceptance.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	4	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	9	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	SDLC order	Planning → analysis (requirements) → design → implementation → maintenance; requirements come before vendor selection or design.	Picking a vendor or building screens before documenting requirements.	An approved project and a pushy vendor or eager designer.
2	RTO vs. RPO	RTO = how long a system can be down; RPO = how much data, measured in time, can be lost.	Swapping the two, or thinking frequent backups meet any RPO.	“Back online within...” (RTO) vs. “no more than ... of data lost” (RPO).
3	Incremental vs. differential backups	Incremental restore = last full + every incremental since; differential restore = last full + the latest differential only.	Using the differential restore rule for incrementals or vice versa.	Backup type and the day of failure.
4	Business continuity vs. disaster recovery	The business continuity plan keeps operations running (downtime procedures); the disaster recovery plan restores IT systems.	Assuming the IT recovery plan tells clinicians how to keep working.	Who must keep working during an outage.
5	Ticket prioritization	Priority = impact × urgency; patient-safety and widespread outages come first.	First-come, first-served or loudest caller first.	A list of tickets with different scopes of impact.
6	Critical path	Project duration equals the longest path through dependent tasks; tasks with slack can slip up to their slack without delaying the finish.	Adding every task, or using the shortest path.	Tasks running in parallel with dependencies.
7	Conversion strategies	Parallel = lowest risk, highest cost; direct (big bang) cutover = lowest cost, highest risk; pilot = one unit first; phased = modules or sites over time.	Calling direct cutover low risk because it is simple.	Budget, staff capacity, and tolerance for risk.
8	Testing types	Unit tests components, integration tests connections, user acceptance testing has end users confirm the system meets their needs, regression checks that changes didn't break existing functions.	Confusing UAT with technical testing.	Who is doing the testing and why.

Course scope (public description): Healthcare System Applications introduces students to information systems. This course includes important topics related to management of information systems (MIS), such as system development and business continuity. The course also provides an overview of management tools and issue tracking systems. This course has no prerequisites.